

Session Objectives

1. **Define** essential terminology crucial for comprehending proper documentation and billing in medical practice.
2. **Compare and contrast** the distinctions among ICD-10 codes, Evaluation and Management (E/M) codes, and Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) codes
3. **Determine** the requisite documentation elements for an office visit, encompassing osteopathic manipulative treatment (OMT)
4. **Explain** the process of billing for an office visit and OMT as a procedural service, incorporating the appropriate use of Modifier -25
5. **Provide** an overview of all components necessary for billing OMT services, including somatic dysfunction documentation by regions treated, techniques utilized, and patient response to treatment

Framework – Importance medical billing and coding

- The backbone of the healthcare revenue cycle, ensuring payers and patients reimburse providers for services delivered.
- Medical billing and coding translates a patient encounter into the languages healthcare facilities use for claims submission and reimbursement.
- Medical coding involves extracting billable information from the medical record and clinical documentation.
- Utilizing these codes, medical billing generates insurance claims and bills for patients, streamlining the reimbursement process.
- Understanding the fundamentals of medical billing and coding ensures physicians to maximize allowable reimbursement for delivering quality care.
- Errors in coding and billing can have severe repercussions, impacting revenue streams, diminishing value, and potentially jeopardizing medical licenses.

Key terminology

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- International Classification of Diseases, 10th revision (ICD 10)
 - A code set providers use to report **medical diagnoses including Osteopathic diagnoses** on all types of claims for services rendered in the United States.
 - These are codes used in the **Assessment** section of the note
- Current Procedural Terminology code (CPT)
 - A medical set of descriptive terms and identifying codes used to report medical, surgical, and diagnostic procedures
 - These are codes that we use to bill for a service we provide in the clinic, hospital, operating room, etc.
- Evaluation and Management code (E/M)
 - A category of CPT codes used for the purpose of billing
 - Used to bill your history and associated evaluation and management services for every patient.

The Note: Subjective/History

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- When evaluating a patient for a complaint where OMT is performed:
 - Pertinent HPI must be present
 - Example: For a patient with headache - we need onset, progression, provocation/palliation, what have they tried, associated symptoms aura, sinus pressure/pain and location if present. (OPQRSTA)
 - Past medical history
 - Includes medications, supplements, and allergies
 - Past surgical history
 - Family history
 - Depending on the chief complaint, you need to ask about: Parents, siblings, and children histories
 - Social history
 - Occupation, living situation, ETOH, Drugs, Exercise, etc.

The Note: Assessment/Diagnoses

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- All diagnoses:
 - Also known as International Classification of Disease (ICD) codes
 - Currently on the 10th revision
 - All have a letter and number designation
 - Example: G43.119 Migraine with aura, intractable, without status migrainosus
- For every visit where OMT is performed:
 1. List all your Medical Diagnoses that you obtained a history and performed a physical exam on first (G43.119)
 2. After you have listed your medical diagnoses, then you will list the ICD 10 code(s) that corresponds to the region(s) of the body where manipulation was performed.
 - Remember: There are 10 body regions- Head, Cervical, Thoracic, Rib, Upper extremity, abdomen, lumbar, sacrum, pelvis, lower extremity
 - Example: M99.00 Segmental and Somatic Dysfunction of the Head region

Assessments – ICD 10 codes

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List your assessment with most pertinent patient presentation.

Somatic dysfunction (SD) should never be only code of the first diagnostic code. A SD does not justify an office visit.

Sample:

Assessment: (ICD-10):

1. G43.119 Migraine with aura, intractable, without status migrainosus
2. M54.2 Cervicalgia (Neck Pain)
3. W56.12 Struck by sea lion
4. M99.00 Somatic dysfunction of head region
5. M99.01 Somatic dysfunction of cervical region
6. M99.02 Somatic dysfunction of thoracic region
7. M99.08 Segmental and somatic dysfunction of rib cage



The Note: Plan

- If an evaluation was performed and during your medical decision making process you feel that OMT would help your patient and you perform this procedure on your patient:
 - You need to document it as such in your plan so that an auditor or colleague will know that both were performed.
 - EXAMPLE: “Based on **today’s physical exam, OMT was performed to the above regions using MFR, BLT, HVLA, Still Technique, counterstrain...**”
 - The “above areas” are the somatic dysfunction regions listed in the assessment section of the note that also correspond to the OSE exam findings in each of the regions listed in the objective section of the note.

MDM

E/M Code	Level of MDM (2 out of 3 Elements)	Number and Complexity of Problem Addressed	Amount and/or Complexity of Data to be Reviewed and Analyzed	Risk of Complications and/or Morbidity or Mortality of Patient Management
99202: 15-29 minutes 99212: 10-19 minutes	Straightforward	1 self-limited or minor problem	Minimal or None	Minimal risk of morbidity from additional diagnostic testing or treatment
99203: 30-44 minutes 99213: 29-29 minutes	Low	2 or more self-limited or minor problem Or 1 stable chronic condition Or Acute, uncomplicated illness or injury	Must meet requirements of I of the 2 categories Category 1: Test and Documents Any combination of 2 from the list below. Or Category 2: Assessment requiring an independent historian(s)	Low risk of morbidity from additional diagnostic testing or treatment
99204: 45-59 minutes 99214: 30-29 minutes	Moderate	1 or more chronic illnesses with exacerbation, progressions, or side effects of treatment Or 2 or more stable chronic illnesses Or 1 undiagnosed new problem with uncertain prognosis Or 1 acute illness with systemic symptoms Or 1 acute complicated injury	Must meet requirements of I of the 3 categories Category 1: Test and Documents, or Independent Historian(s) Any combination of 3 from the list below. Or Category 2: Independent Interpretation of Test Independent interpretation of a test performed by another physician or other health care professional Or Category 3: Discussion of Management or Test Interpretation Discussion of management or test interpretation with external physician or other health care professional	Moderate risk of morbidity from additional diagnostic testing or treatment Examples - Prescription drug management - Decision regarding minor surgery with identified patient or procedure risk factors - Decision regarding elective major surgery without identified patient or procedure risk factors - Diagnosis or treatment significantly limited by social determinants of health
99205: 60-74 minutes 99215: 40-54 minutes	High	1 or more chronic illnesses with severe exacerbation, progression, or side effects of treatment Or 1 acute chronic illness or injury that poses a threat to life or bodily function	Must meet requirements of 2 of the 3 categories Category 1: Test and Documents, or Independent Historian(s) Any combination of 3 from the list below. Or Category 2: Independent Interpretation of Test Independent interpretation of a test performed by another physician or other health care professional Or Category 3: Discussion of Management or Test Interpretation Discussion of management or test interpretation with external physician or other health care professional	High risk of morbidity from additional diagnostic testing or treatment Examples - Drug therapy requiring intensive monitoring for toxicity - Decision regarding elective major surgery without identified patient or procedure risk factors - Decision regarding emergency major - Decision regarding hospitalization - Decision not to resuscitate or to de-escalate care because of poor prognosis



OMT Billing

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OMT is a manual treatment focused on addressing somatic dysfunctions of neuromuscular structures and it's associated with medical conditions and its effects on other body systems.

- **OMT is a PROCEDURE.**
- This occurs in addition to completing an evaluation of the patient including obtaining a pertinent history, completing a physical exam, and determining whether OMT is appropriate as a part of the medical decision-making process.

OMT Billing – CPT codes for procedures

- Billed based on the number or body regions treated
 - **10 Regions:** Head (includes the OA & hyoid), cervical, thoracic, rib, lumbar, abdomen, sacrum, pelvis (innominates & pubic bones), upper extremities, and lower extremities
 - Remember: even though most patients will have two upper extremities-they do not count as separate regions.
 - CPT Codes:
 - 98925: OMT to **1-2 body regions**
 - 98926: OMT to **3-4 body regions**
 - 98927: OMT to **5-6 body regions**
 - 98928: OMT to **7-8 body regions**
 - 98929: OMT to **9-10 body regions**

25 Modifier

- Definition: a billing code that is used when separately identifiable services are provided on the same day of service.
- Therefore, in an office visit encounter where OMT is performed, you would bill for an E/M code , a 25 modifier, and a separate CPT code for the OMT performed.

Billing Information:

Visit Code:

99213 Office Visit, Est Pt., Level 3. Modifiers: 25

Procedure Codes:

98927 OSTEOPATHIC MANIPULATION.

- Exception to the rule:
 - If you evaluate the patient and determine the need for OMT on one day and have the patient return on a different day specifically for OMT.
 - Plan: “Based on previous PE, OMT was performed to the above regions using...”

Putting it together

- Office visit. Patient seen and evaluated, OMT performed for headache
- E/M: 99213 (est patient, mod complex)
- Diagnosis (ICD-10):
 1. HA (R.51) [SD should never be only of 1st dx code – does not justify office visit]
 2. M99.00 Somatic dysfunction of head region
 3. M99.01 Somatic dysfunction of cervical region
 4. M99.02 Somatic dysfunction of thoracic region
 5. M99.08 Segmental and somatic dysfunction of rib cage
- Procedure (CPT): 98926 - OMT 4 regions
- Add -25 modifier → 99213 -25 mod 98926

Summary

- Proper understanding of coding and billing practices for medical visits is crucial for securing accurate reimbursement.
- Inadequate documentation and incorrect billing can have serious consequences.
- Governmental guidelines governing coding and billing are subject to frequent changes, necessitating continuous updates.
- Physicians bear the ultimate responsibility for ensuring adherence to coding and billing standards.
- Thorough documentation of OMT, precise coding for SD assessments, and meticulous billing procedures are essential for securing proper reimbursement.